EXPERIMENT 7: INTEGRATING A ZOHO CREATOR APPLICATION WITH ANOTHER ZOHO SERVICE USING CONNECTIONS AND APIS

Aim

To integrate the Zoho Creator Automated Corporate Talent Acquisition and Interview Tracking System with another Zoho service (such as Zoho CRM or Zoho Recruit) using pre-built Connections, Deluge integration tasks, and REST APIs for seamless data synchronization, automated lead/candidate record creation, and cross-platform recruitment management.

Theory

In modern cloud architectures, enterprise low-code platforms must interoperate with specialized enterprise applications. Zoho Creator facilitates standard data exchange and workflow extension through its integrated Connections mechanism, built-in Deluge integration tasks, and auto-generated REST APIs.

Key integration concepts utilized in this module include:

- **Connections & OAuth 2.0 Authentication:** Connections in Zoho Creator store secure authentication details (OAuth 2.0 client credentials, scopes, and refresh tokens) required to interact with external Zoho ecosystem services or third-party cloud APIs without hardcoding sensitive access keys in scripts.
- **Deluge Integration Tasks:** Deluge provides native wrappers for Zoho services (e.g., zoho.crm.create(), zoho.crm.searchRecords(), zoho.crm.updateRecord(), and zoho.recruit.post()) that simplify CRUD (Create, Read, Update, Delete) operations across ecosystem products with minimal script footprint.
- **Integration Field Type:** Zoho Creator supports specialized Integration fields that directly link records in a Creator form to modules in external Zoho applications (such as Zoho CRM Leads, Contacts, or Deals), maintaining relational integrity across systems.
- **Outbound Webhooks & REST APIs (invokeurl):** For custom endpoints and advanced REST interactions, Deluge utilizes the invokeurl statement to send structured HTTP requests (GET, POST, PUT, DELETE) with custom headers, query parameters, and JSON/XML payloads.
- **Cross-Platform Workflow Automation:** Automating interactions between Zoho Creator and Zoho CRM/Recruit ensures that selected candidates or job requisitions in Creator automatically create or update records in CRM, maintaining real-time alignment across sales, HR, and talent acquisition teams.

Procedure

1. Log in to Zoho Creator and open the existing Automated Corporate Talent Acquisition and Interview Tracking System application.

2. Navigate to Setup / Settings and select Connections under the Developer Tools section.

3. Click Add Connection, select Zoho Services, choose Zoho CRM (or Zoho Recruit), select the required OAuth scopes (e.g., ZohoCRM.modules.ALL), and authorize the connection named Zoho_CRM_Conn.

4. Open the Candidate Application form in the Form Builder workspace.

5. Add an Integration Field (or lookup reference) linking candidate profiles to the Zoho CRM Leads/Contacts module.

6. Navigate to Workflows and create an On Success workflow on the Candidate Application form to automatically create a corresponding Lead or Contact record in Zoho CRM whenever a new application is submitted.

7. Write a Deluge integration script using zoho.crm.create() to map candidate fields (First Name, Last Name, Email, Phone, Applied Position) to Zoho CRM Lead fields.

8. Configure an On Success workflow on the Interview Evaluation form using zoho.crm.updateRecord() to update the candidate status or lead rating in Zoho CRM based on final interview evaluation results.

9. Create an On Load or On User Input workflow on the Job Requisition form that uses zoho.crm.searchRecords() to dynamically fetch relevant sales account manager details from Zoho CRM.

10. Perform integration testing by submitting a sample candidate record in Zoho Creator and verifying that the record is immediately instantiated in Zoho CRM.

11. Check the Executed Script Logs and API usage dashboards in Zoho Creator to verify successful HTTP responses (Status Code 200/201) and confirm data payload accuracy.

Sample Deluge Scripts & Integration Logic

Below are reference Deluge code implementations configured and tested during the integration experiment:

1. On Success Workflow: Automatic Lead Creation in Zoho CRM

```
// On Success Event - Candidate Application Form
leadMap = Map();
leadMap.put("First_Name", input.First_Name);
leadMap.put("Last_Name", input.Last_Name);
leadMap.put("Email", input.Email);
leadMap.put("Phone", input.Phone_Number);
leadMap.put("Description", "Candidate applied for position: " +
input.Applied_Position);
leadMap.put("Lead_Source", "Zoho Creator Candidate Portal");

response = zoho.crm.create("Leads", leadMap, "Zoho_CRM_Conn");
info "Zoho CRM Lead Creation Response: " + response;
```

2. On Success Workflow: Updating Record Status in Zoho CRM

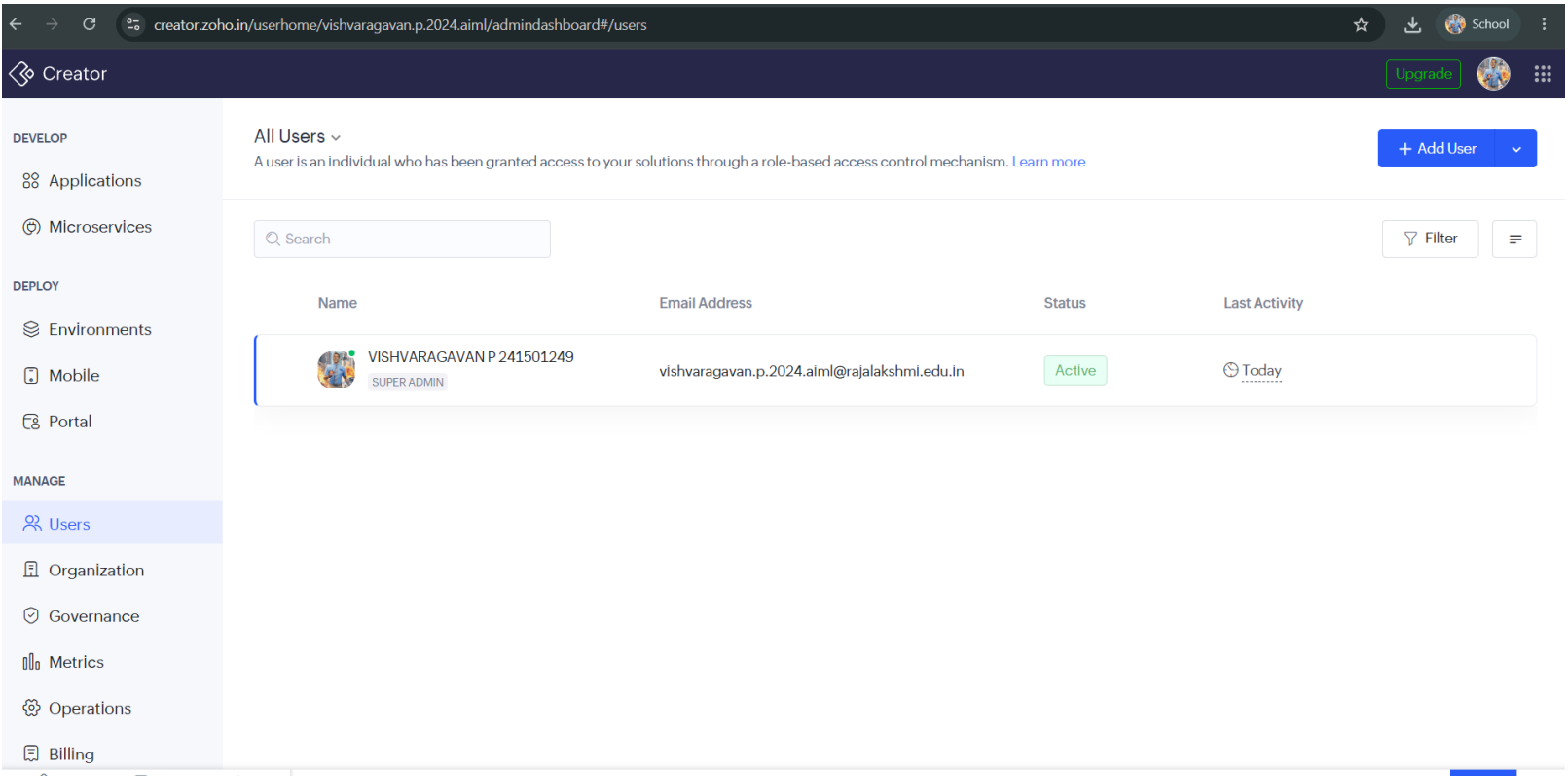
```
// On Success Event - Interview Evaluation Form
crmLeadId = input.CRM_Lead_ID;
if (crmLeadId != null && crmLeadId != "")
{
    updateMap = Map();
    if (input.Final_Decision == "Selected")
    {
        updateMap.put("Rating", "Acquired");
        updateMap.put("Lead_Status", "Qualified");
    }
    else if (input.Final_Decision == "Rejected")
    {
        updateMap.put("Lead_Status", "Junk Lead");
    }
    updateResponse = zoho.crm.updateRecord("Leads", crmLeadId.toLong(), updateMap,
"Zoho_CRM_Conn");
    info "CRM Update Result: " + updateResponse;
}
```

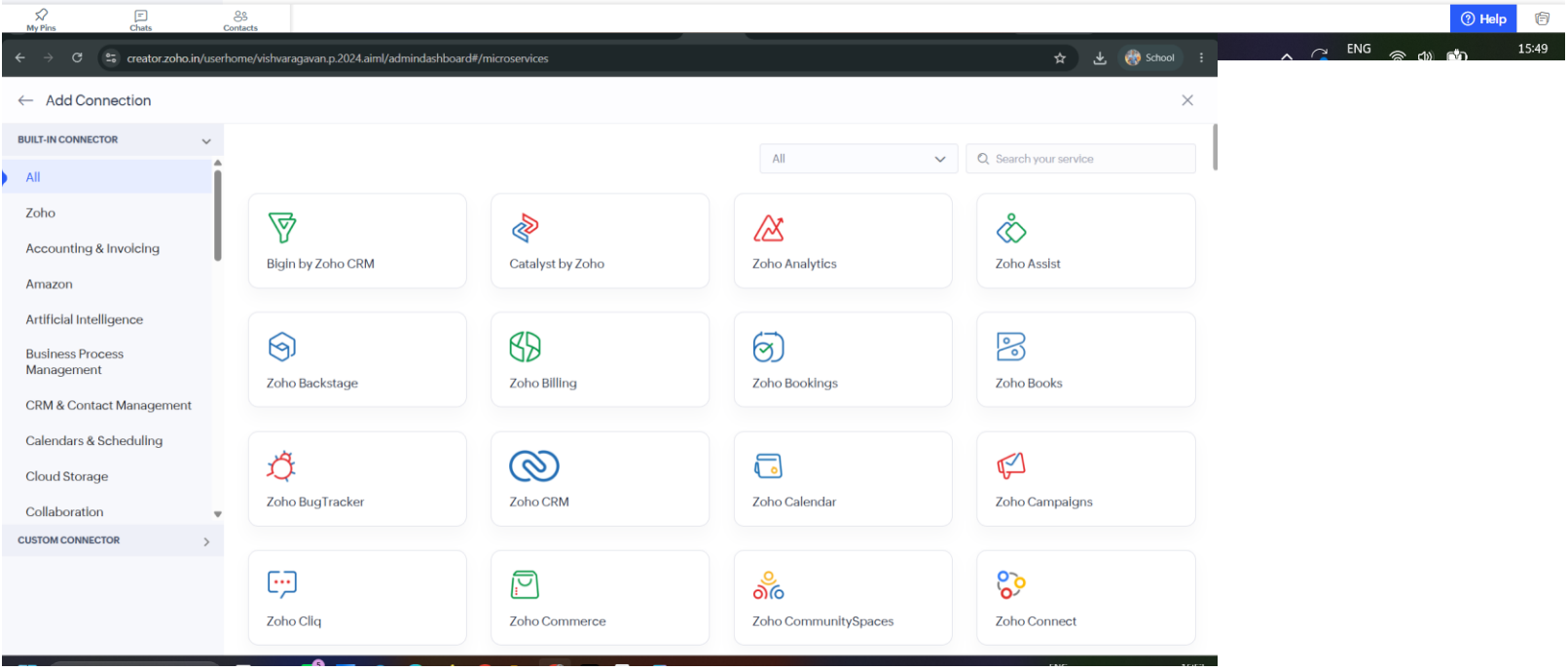
3. On User Input Workflow: Searching Records in Zoho CRM

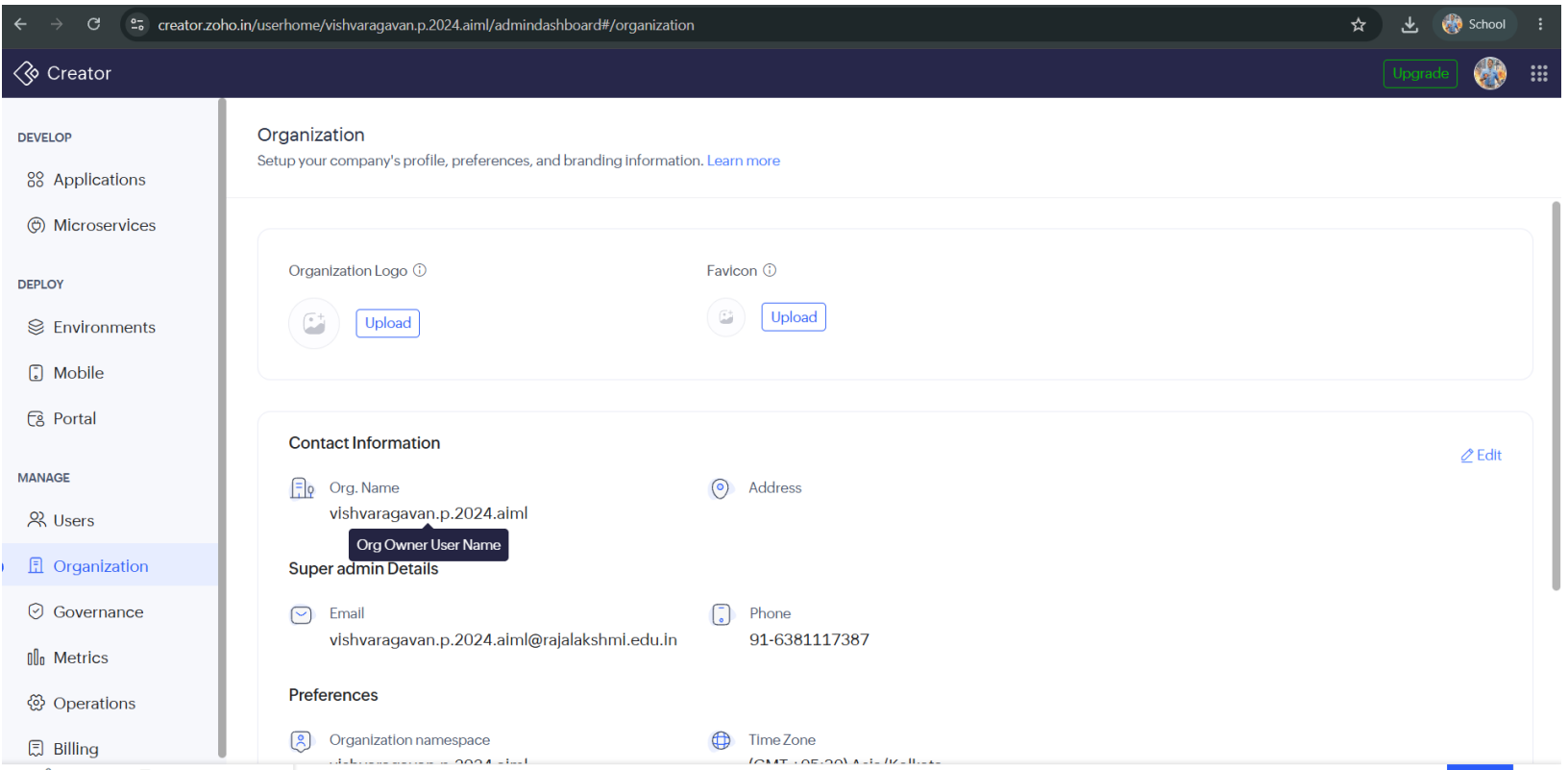
```
// On User Input Event - Candidate Email Search
searchCriteria = "(Email:equals:" + input.Email + ")";
searchResult = zoho.crm.searchRecords("Leads", searchCriteria, 1, 1,
"Zoho_CRM_Conn");
if (searchResult.size() > 0)
{
    matchedLead = searchResult.get(0);
    input.CRM_Lead_ID = matchedLead.get("id");
    alert "Existing Lead record found in Zoho CRM with ID: " +
matchedLead.get("id");
}
```

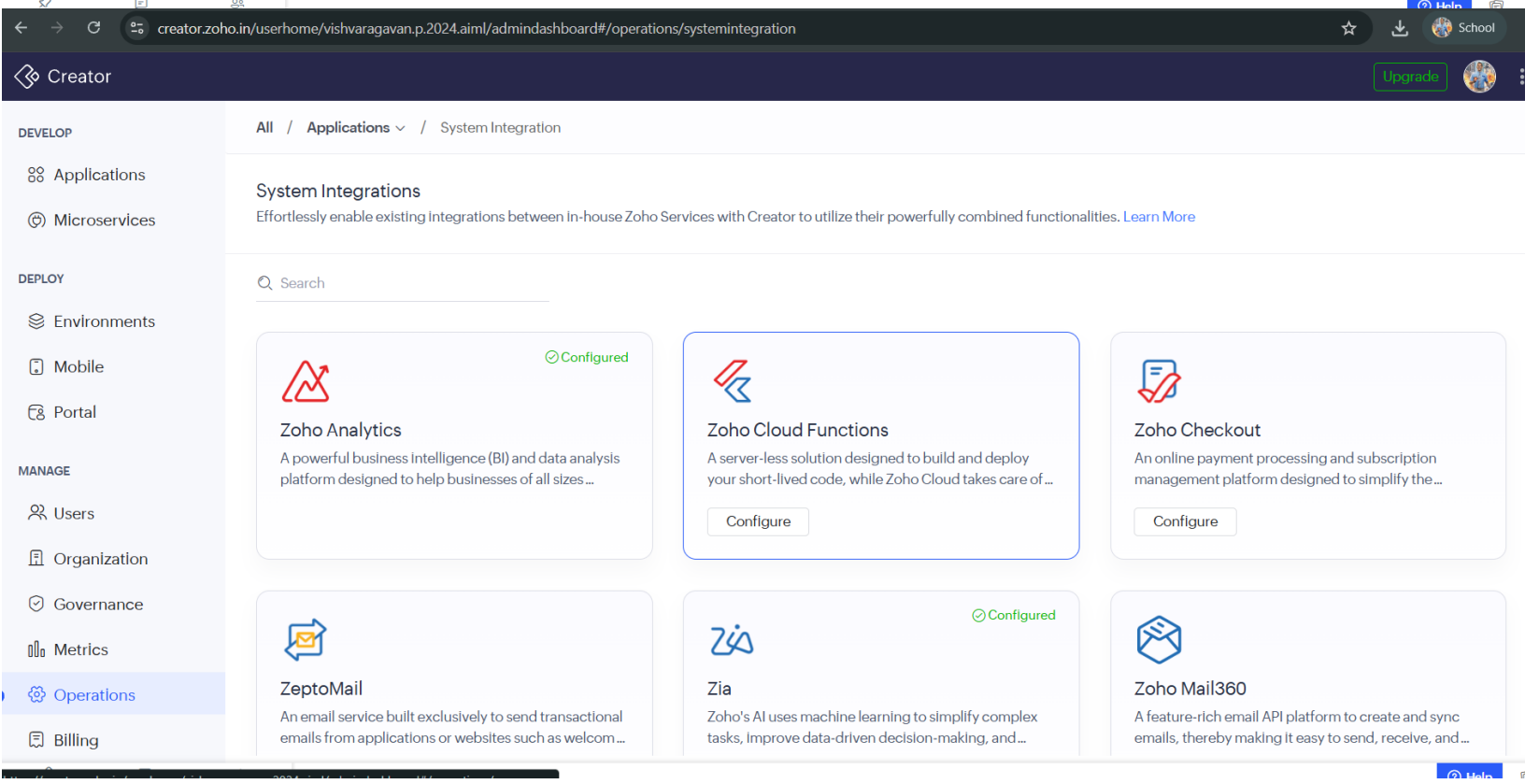
4. Generic Outbound REST API Invocation using invokeurl

```
// Outbound REST API Call using invokeurl & Connection
endpointUrl = "https://www.zohoapis.in/crm/v2/Leads/search?email=" + input.Email;
apiResponse = invokeurl
[
    url : endpointUrl
    type : GET
    connection : "Zoho_CRM_Conn"
];
info "REST API Direct Response: " + apiResponse;
```


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Result

Thus, the Zoho Creator Automated Corporate Talent Acquisition and Interview Tracking System application was successfully integrated with Zoho CRM using OAuth 2.0 connections, Deluge integration tasks, and REST APIs. Data synchronization, record creation, searching, and cross-platform status updates were thoroughly tested and verified.